

Anne and Mike Roy

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October 14, 2021

Federal Maritime Commission

RE: Docket No. 20-15, Comments on PVO Financial Responsibility Rulemaking

Dear Commissioner:

This letter is to comment on your panel to review rules governing cruise trip cancellations amid the Covid-19 epidemic.

My husband and I booked a cruise trip for \$22,990 through Cruisebuilders, Inc. of Utah, which included airfare, 14 days aboard Costa Cruise Line, several land excursions (Italy, Croatia, Israel, Greece), and VIP INNER Circle access, all highlighted to be conducted by some high-profile speakers. We purchased the trip on July 2019 and completed our payment on November 2019 as was detailed by the cruise trip agent for acceptance of our reservation. This agent, Cruisebuilders, Inc., postponed the original beginning date of March 25, 2020 until May 2021, then October 25, 2021, and finally cancelled the trip on September 2, 2021. We also purchased trip insurance for \$1892 for any trouble e had along the trip.

In April 2020, our doctors advised us not to travel abroad but the insurance said the did not cover covid-19 issues. Then when the cruise was cancelled because "several countries were not allowing tourist ships to dock at their ports and other due to other pandemic restrictions and requirements". We were offered vouchers for the full amount of the trip which included speaker's fees and inner circle access. However, a cash refund was refused. We have contacted the insurance agent with no response as well. The terms and conditions of the agent stated in paragraph 20 "Cruisebuilders reserves the right to cancel or reschedule for any reason. If a vacation is cancelled prior to departure, Cruisebuilders' only responsibility will be to refund the amount received for the reservation".

We have made several appeals to the agent and the only answer is to restate the vouchers. We don't want the vouchers because we only agreed to the trip due to the speakers but now the speakers are not scheduled in the future so we won't get our money's worth. To us, the cruise was for the speakers, not for a cruise.

I appreciate you taking this into consideration and even help us obtain a refund of \$22,990.

Sincerely,

Anne and Mike Roy

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